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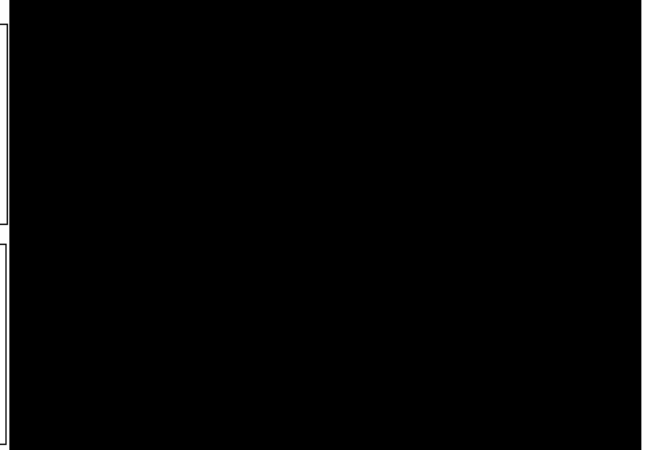
**Department of the Air Force: Justification for Other Than Full and Open Competition**

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**Dollar Value of this Acquisition:**    ☒ ≤ \$10M    ☐ > \$10M and ≤ \$100M    ☐ > \$100M and ≤ \$500M    ☐ > \$500M

**CERTIFICATIONS:** CO certification serves as J&A approval ≤ \$10M, *See [J&A Template Guidance](https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFCC/AQCP/KnowledgeCenter/SitePages/DAF-Contracting-Compass/Part-6---Competition-Requirements.aspx) at <https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFCC/AQCP/KnowledgeCenter/SitePages/DAF-Contracting-Compass/Part-6---Competition-Requirements.aspx>* for completing the J&A sections and J&A Approval Guidance

|           |                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Date      | Contracting Officer (RFO 6.104-1(12))<br>Joshua Connelly<br><br>I certify that this justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.          |
| 16Apr2026 | Technical and Requirements Personnel (RFO 6.104(b))<br>Tige Everson<br><br>I certify that the supporting data herein, which is my responsibility, is accurate and complete. |



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**COORDINATION**

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**APPROVALS ( RFO 6.104-2(a) Table 6-1 & R-DFARS 206.104-72 Table 206.1)**

See [J&A Template Guidance](https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFCC/AQCP/KnowledgeCenter/SitePages/DAF-Contracting-Compass/Part-6---Competition-Requirements.aspx) (<https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFCC/AQCP/KnowledgeCenter/SitePages/DAF-Contracting-Compass/Part-6---Competition-Requirements.aspx>) - J&A Approval Guidelines

**NOTE 1:** A signature block will appear here (replacing these notes) based on the "Dollar Value of this Acquisition" selected above. Since most digital signatures that include date/time-stamps are redacted before they are made publicly available, always insert the date in the "Date" cell when affixing a digital signature to this document.

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**I. Agency and Contracting Activity (RFO 6.104-1(a)(1)):**

Agency: Air Combat Command (ACC)

Contracting Activity: 55th Contracting Squadron (55 CONS)

**II. Nature and/or description of the action being approved (RFO 6.104-1(a)(2)):**

This document approves the award of a call order on a sole source basis to Carahsoft Technology Corp for VMware Cloud Foundation software licenses and 24/7 telephone support for the 55th Communications Squadron's virtual datacenter infrastructure. This justification is made on an individual basis.

**III. Description of supplies/services required to meet agency needs (RFO 6.104-1(a)(3)):**

Base Year - End Date: 05 August 2026 -

Option year 1 - End Date: 05 August 2027 -

Option year 2 - End Date: 05 August 2028 -

Option year 3 - End Date: 05 August 2029 -

Option year 4 - End Date: 05 August 2030 -

Total Price:

Services include the following IAW 55 CS Statement of Need:

- 24/7 telephone support of virtual datacenter infrastructure.
- Contractor will provide all necessary software components, ensuring compatibility, security, and long-term support.
- The software manufacturer shall provide ongoing support and escalation procedures.
- The software manufacture provided shall provide proactive maintenance, security updates, and patches at no additional cost to the government.

**IV. Statutory Authority Permitting Other Than Full and Open Competition (RFO 6.104-1(a)(4)):**

10 U.S.C. 3204(a)(1), Only one responsible source and no other supplies or services will satisfy agency requirements.

**V. Rationale for Use of Authority (RFO 6.104-1(a)(5)):**

The 55th Communications Squadron at Offutt AFB, Nebraska, has an ongoing requirement to purchase software licenses for existing Virtualization Infrastructure utilizing the Broadcom VSphere application supporting Voice Over IP (VoIP), Identity Services Engine (ISE), and NIPR and [REDACTED]. The 55 CS requirement can only be fulfilled by the specified software products to maintain the integrity and compatibility with current system configurations. If alternative software vendors are used, it would incur an estimated cost [REDACTED] for new software acquisition, integration with existing hardware, training, and contractor installation.

The Defense Information Technology Contracting Organization (DITCO) contracting office awarded BPA No. HC108425A0002 to Carahsoft Technology Corp on 06 August 2025; the BPA has a 5-year (one-year base

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ordering period, with 4 (one-year) option periods) that ends on 05 August 2030 if all options are exercised. This agreement for VMware by Broadcom was competitively awarded to Carahsoft Technology Corp there is no need to solicit requirement(s) on GSA or any other MAS vehicle.

The VMware by Broadcom BPA is a multi-year contract that leverages the buying power of 2.9 million DoD personnel (4th Estate Agencies / Defense Agencies and Field Activities (DAFA), United States Air Force, United States Space Force, and Combatant Commands (COCOMs)) to offer cost savings, improve acquisition and deployment, and asset visibility across the DoD to aid in the elimination of redundancy.

Additionally, on 18 March 2026, the Office of the DAF Chief Information Officer (SAF/CN) published a memo with subject: Department of the Air Force (DAF) Mandatory Use of DISA VMware by Broadcom Blanket Purchase Agreement (BPA). The memo states the following:

"This memorandum directs all DAF organizations, including all Major Commands (MAJCOMs), Field Commands (FLDCOMs), Field Operating Agencies (FOAs), and Direct Reporting Units (DRUs), on mandatory use of the recently established DISA Enterprise Agreement for VMware by Broadcom for the procurement of all new and renewal Broadcom VMware software licenses and maintenance IAW DAFMAN 17-1203, Section 3.2. This single award agreement provides a unified vehicle for acquiring Broadcom/VMware software and services, ensuring consistent pricing, improved terms and conditions, and enhanced cybersecurity compliance across the enterprise. Centralizing procurement under this BPA is critical to driving cost efficiency, accelerating capability access, and modernizing the DAF's IT infrastructure and security posture.

### a. Mandatory Use

Effective immediately, the DISA VMware by Broadcom BPA is the sole and mandatory source for all DAF requirements for Broadcom provided services and VMware software and must be fulfilled through this agreement, including but not limited to new procurement and renewal of software licenses and subscriptions; software maintenance and support renewals; product upgrades and technical services; cloud and hybrid platform solutions (e.g., VMware Cloud Foundation). The initiation of any new, independent procurement actions for Broadcom VMware products or services through other contract vehicles or open market sources is prohibited.

### b. Required Actions

Transition to BPA: All existing VMware contract holders with upcoming renewals or those with new or emerging requirements must coordinate with their respective local contracting office to utilize the BPA. All call orders will be co-termed to the BPA base year period of performance ending August 5, 2026."

## VI. Integrated Market Analysis and Efforts to Solicit Competition (RFO 6.104-1(a)(6), (8), and (10)):

A Sources Sought was posted to SAM.gov on 13 Mar 2026 and response date of 30 Mar 2026. The title of the sources sought was VMware by Broadcom VSphere application (VCF-CLD-FND) with Notice ID FA4600\_VMware\_or\_Equal. Initially, the sources sought was posted to align with RFO Part 19, specifically RFO 19.101(a) where "It is the Government's policy to provide maximum practicable opportunities in its acquisitions to small business and other small business socioeconomic categories."

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Furthermore, this sources sought was intended to also serve as a presolicitation notice IAW RFO 5.101, following procedures to post a presolicitation notice on SAM.gov for at least 15 days due this acquisition's expected contract value to be greater than the SAT of \$350K (expected value of contract is estimated to be [REDACTED]). The Office of the DAF Chief Information Officer (SAF/CN) published a memo with subject: Department of the Air Force (DAF) Mandatory Use of DISA VMware by Broadcom Blanket Purchase Agreement (BPA) on 18 March 2026, directing contracting offices to pursue this mandatory use BPA for all new and renewal requirements for VMware software. This memo was not known until provided by the mission partner on 24 March 2026. The Sources Sought notice was ended early on 27 March 2026 as a result of obtaining the mandatory use memo.

The results of the sources sought yielded interest from 7 small businesses. These are the 7 businesses listed in chronological order of receiving an interested party email:

1. BHPE LLC (UPDJHPJUYQ71).
2. AIQSO LLC (JM4VBD7M51G4).
3. NSFL CAPITAL LLC (UKD4HBKLZR76).
4. PIC'D GROUP LLC (F1LCM8MDB7L3).
5. DELTEK INC (X33ZSBRJNNL9).
6. TRYFACTA INC (DNXNJJDKLYM6).
7. RIMINI STREET, INC (GJDJTK9DJEH4).

The key capabilities vendors were required to prove to be considered viable was the following as listed in the sources sought synopsis: "If offerors have an alternative source that can meet the same capabilities as VMWare Cloud Foundation, Product ID VCF-CLD-FND, and the product is able to communicate appropriately with other products on this software, please submit a capabilities statement with technical data supporting the alternative offering."

[REDACTED]

**VII. Determination of Fair and Reasonable Cost (RFO 6.104-1(a)(7)):**

The Contracting Officer is responsible for evaluating, determining, and documenting the anticipated contract cost/price is fair and reasonable in accordance with RFO Subpart 15.4, Contract Pricing.

**VIII. Any Other Facts Supporting the Justification (RFO 6.104-1(a)(9)):**

[REDACTED]

Quoting from the Defense Information Systems Agency Ordering Guide for VMware by Broadcom, there is specific verbiage that suggests soliciting quotes for competition is not necessary:

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"The Defense Information Technology Contracting Organization (DITCO) contracting office awarded BPA No. HC108425A0002 to Carahsoft Technology Corp on 06 August 2025; the BPA has a 5-year (one-year base ordering period, with 4 (one-year) option periods) that ends on 05 August 2030 if all options are exercised. **This agreement for VMware by Broadcom was competitively awarded to Carahsoft Technology Corp** there is no need to solicit requirement(s) on GSA or any other MAS vehicle."

"The BPA for VMware by Broadcom was competitively sourced against all VMware resellers who possessed GSA schedules and agreed to the Terms and Conditions (Ts&Cs) included in the BPA. A single BPA was awarded to Carahsoft Technology Corp. in accordance with FAR 8.405- 3(c)(1); **therefore, no further competition on individual delivery orders is required.**"

**IX. Actions to Overcome Barriers to Competition (RFO 6.104-1(a)(11):**

While at this time, VMware by Broadcom acquisitions are sole-sourced to Carahsoft Technology Corp. until 05 August 2030 as directed by the USAF Memo, multiple small businesses seem interested and capable of meeting future VMware requirements. Given the high security requirements of the USAF when it comes to selecting IT products, there will likely always be mandatory sources for IT procurement and barriers to competition in IT will persist.